

NUMBER-TO-WORD CONVERTER

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Many a times, business reports are required to show numbers in word equivalents.

In financial domain, the amount is printed in both figures and words, for example, in bills, vouchers, bank drafts and cheques. A simple example of printing the amount in words

could be observed in bank drafts, say, as 'rupees one seven six five only' for Rs 1765. Another example could be printing the quantity of the item in words.

Crystal Report, a popular report writer software, uses 'toWords()' function to

convert a number into its word equivalent. Unfortunately, it follows the US numbering system and cannot be used for the Indian numbering system (refer Table I).

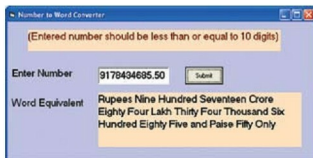
Here we describe a program written in Visual Basic 6.0 to convert a number into its word equivalent suitable for the Indian numbering system and currency. The program code is simple and easily understandable, and can be customised as per a currency and number system.

Software program

The program code contains four main functions—Word, TwoDigitToWord, ThreeDigitToWord and toWords—each returning a string output. Before delving into function details, refer to Table II for the standard Visual Basic 6 functions used in the code.

The Word function returns the word corresponding to the number passed by the argument list. The code listed below, which includes word function and case statements, is used to construct the word equivalents of the numbers:

```
Function Word(ByVal lngNum As Long)
As String
Select Case lngNum
Case 1: Word = "One"
Case 2: Word = "Two"
Case 3: Word = "Three"
Case 4: Word = "Four"
Case 5: Word = "Five"
Case 6: Word = "Six"
Case 7: Word = "Seven"
Case 8: Word = "Eight"
Case 9: Word = "Nine"
Case 10: Word = "Ten"
Case 11: Word = "Eleven"
Case 12: Word = "Twelve"
Case 13: Word = "Thirteen"
Case 14: Word = "Fourteen"
Case 15: Word = "Fifteen"
```



Screenshot of the program output of the number-to-word converter

TABLE I
Numbering Systems

Number	US & France	UK & Europe	India
100,000	One hundred thousand	One hundred thousand	One lakh
1,000,000	One million	One million	Ten lakhs
10,000,000	Ten million	Ten million	One crore
100,000,000	One hundred million	One hundred million	Ten crores
1,000,000,000	One billion	One milliard (one thousand million)	Hundred crores

Courtesy: Manorama Year Book 1999

TABLE II
Standard Visual Basic Functions

Functions	Description
CInt(string)	Returns an integer containing the string
CStr(number)	Returns a string containing the number
Int(number)	Returns the integer portion of a number
Len(string)	Returns a length containing the number of characters in a string
LTrim(string)	Returns a string containing a copy of a specified string without leading spaces
Mid(string, start[, length])	Returns a string containing a specified number of characters from a string
Round(expression [, numdecimalplaces])	Returns a number rounded to a specified number of decimal places
Space(number)	Returns a string consisting of the specified number of spaces, " " can also be used
String(number, character)	Returns a string containing a repeating character string of the length specified